UK minister: Brits and EU must ‘act in lockstep’ to counter Chinese carmaking dominance

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【要点】

・英国のサワール貿易相は、中国の自動車産業での優位性に対抗するため、英国とEUが協力して「足並みを揃える」必要があると述べ、電動車両関税での一致を支持している。

・ブレグジット後の貿易協定に基づき、2025年初頭から電動車両部品の55%以上が英国またはEU産である必要があり、違反時には10%の関税が課される。

・英国はEUの産業政策プログラムへの参加を求めているが、中国製電動車への関税で英国がEUと足並みを揃えないことが障害となっている。

・EUの産業促進法に基づく政府調達での優遇措置から英国が除外されると、英国メーカーは不利になる可能性がある。

・サワー氏は、過度な保護主義的対応がサプライチェーンに悪影響を与える可能性があるため、英国とEUは相互の懸念を考慮すべきだと主張している。

【メール原文】

LONDON — U.K. Trade Minister Anas Sarwar has said Britain and the European Union must “work together and act in lockstep” to tackle China’s dominance
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UK minister: Brits and EU must ‘act in lockstep’ to counter Chinese carmaking dominance
By Caroline Hug, Stefanie Bolzen · Oct 15, 2026, 1:23 PM · View in your browser

LONDON — U.K. Trade Minister Anas Sarwar has said Britain and the European Union must “work together and act in lockstep” to tackle China’s dominance in the automotive sector, signaling his support for alignment on electric vehicle tariffs.

Asked by POLITICO on the sidelines of the German-British Business Summit at Mansion House whether Britain would consider slapping tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles, Sarwar said discussions with European partners “continue.”

“The automotive sector and partnership remain strong, but do we have to grapple with the challenge that comes from rapid expansion in China? Of course we do,” he said. “The more that the U.K. and the EU work together and act in lockstep, the better it is for both the U.K. and the European Union,” he added.

Britain is working with the European Commission to avoid a 10% electric vehicle tariff from the start of next year, when stricter rules of origin under the Brexit trade deal are due to take effect. The U.K. is also lobbying for British businesses to be included in the EU’s Made in Europe industrial policy program.

Under the tightening rules of the Brexit trade deal, 55% of an electric vehicle's parts must originate in the U.K. or EU to continue to cross the Channel tariff-free. In addition, at least 70% of the battery pack and 65% of a battery's cells must originate in the U.K. or EU.

The separate EU Industrial Accelerator Act, which gives EU-made products preferential treatment in certain public procurement projects, could also leave British manufacturers at a disadvantage, should the country be excluded.

The German government and some EU officials have argued that Britain's refusal to align with the bloc's tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles weakens its case for inclusion.

Speaking to German business leaders and policymakers during his keynote address, Sarwar said the U.K. and its European neighbors face similar challenges.

"We've got muscular protectionism on one side, we've got rapid expansionism on another side, and governments across the world of similar economy sizes to ourselves in Germany are having to work through what does that mean for our supply chains," he said.

"I don't say to our EU colleagues that they shouldn't have a Made in Europe campaign," Sarwar added. "We have a Made in U.K. campaign. ⋯ What I'd say, though, is let's not have unintended consequences by taking the reaction too far and damaging our businesses in the process."

The U.K.'s Business Secretary, Jonathan Reynolds, has indicated he is less bullish on electric vehicle tariffs.

Speaking to POLITICO last month , he said the U.K.'s calculation on whether to impose tariffs differed from that of the EU.

"We are an export-orientated sector. So clearly, you shouldn't do anything that risks your export markets, and you always have to take heed of retaliatory action if you put tariffs in place," he said Sunday, calling the U.K.'s position on Chinese EVs "finely balanced."

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